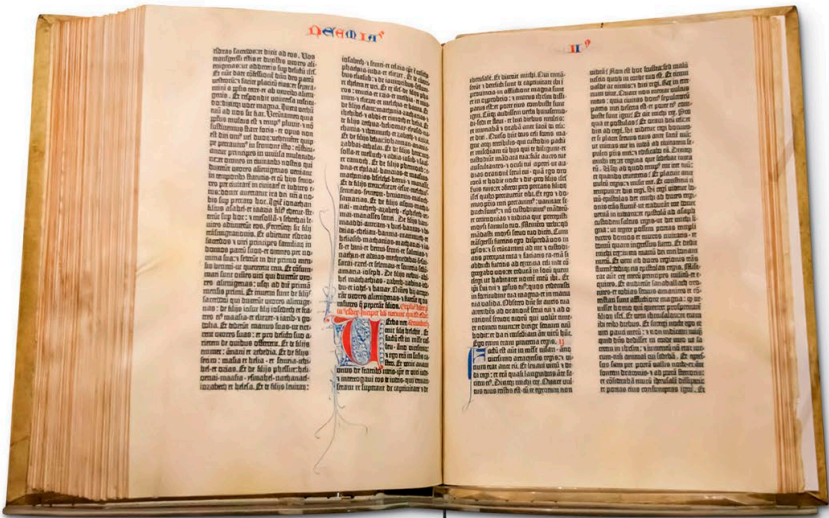


48 copies of the Gutenberg Bible survive today



△ A Gutenberg Bible printed on vellum

1454 GUTENBERG BIBLE

The Bibles printed by Johannes Gutenberg in the German city of Mainz in 1454 were among the first books produced in Europe using moveable metal type. The success of the Gutenberg Bible initiated a revolution in European culture. From the 1470s, presses appeared in many countries, making books widely available. By spreading knowledge and literacy beyond traditional elites, they encouraged people to challenge accepted authority.

1459



△ Aztec human sacrifice

1454 AZTEC FLOWER WARS

Under the rule of Moctezuma I, the Aztec Triple Alliance (of Mexico-Tenochtitlan, Tlacopan, and Tetzcoco) initiated "Flower Wars" – attacks on neighbouring peoples such as the Tlaxcala, Huexotzinco, and Cholula. The Aztecs fought to display prowess and capture prisoners for human sacrifice. These ritualized wars made the Tlaxcala bitter enemies of the Aztecs.

1456 The Ottomans try to subjugate Hungary, and besiege Belgrade, but are beaten back by Janos Hunyadi's forces



1455 WAR OF THE ROSES

For 30 years the English throne was contested between claimants from the House of Lancaster, represented by a red rose, and the white-rose House of York. Victory at Towton in 1461 saw Yorkist Edward IV supplant the ineffectual Lancastrian Henry VI. The Lancastrians finally triumphed when Henry VII seized power from Richard III in 1485.

△ Choosing the Red and White Roses, Henry Payne, 1908